

Name:

Hour:

SAY What does the text say? Direct Quote	MEAN What does this information mean? Make an inference. Interpret and “read between the lines.” • What does the author mean? • Summarize	MATTER Why does it matter? So what? • Why does this information matter? • Why is this important or significant?

1. "Lazy hands make a man poor, but diligent hands bring wealth." ~ Solomon

SAY

People who are lazy become poor, but people who work hard gain wealth.

MEAN

Solomon is saying that effort leads to success. If you try hard and stay focused, you're more likely to reach your goals. If you avoid work, you will struggle.

MATTER

This matters because it reminds students that hard work has real results. It shows the importance of responsibility and effort in school, sports, and life. It connects to ideas about perseverance and making good choices.

2. "The tongue has the power of life and death." ~ Solomon

SAY

Words can build people up or tear them down.

MEAN

Solomon means that what we say has a strong impact. Our words can encourage, help, and comfort others — or they can hurt, insult, and damage relationships.

MATTER

This matters because it shows why we must choose our words carefully. It connects to kindness, bullying prevention, and communication. What we say can change someone's day or even their life.

3. "A good name is rather to be chosen than riches." ~ Solomon

SAY

Having a good reputation is better than having a lot of money.

MEAN

Solomon is saying that being honest, trustworthy, and respected is more valuable than wealth. Character is worth more than riches.

MATTER

This matters because it teaches students that who they are is more important than what they have. It connects to integrity, doing the right thing, and making good choices even when no one is watching.

4. "Fools despise wisdom and instruction." ~ Solomon

SAY

Foolish people hate wisdom and do not want to learn.

MEAN

Solomon means that people who act foolishly ignore advice and refuse to listen or grow. They don't want to learn from others or admit mistakes.

MATTER

This matters because it shows the importance of being teachable. It encourages students to accept feedback, learn from teachers, and stay open to new ideas. It connects to having a growth mindset.

5. “As iron sharpens iron, so a friend sharpens a friend.” ~ Solomon

SAY

Friends can make each other better, like iron sharpening iron.

MEAN

Solomon means that good friends help each other grow, improve, and become stronger people. Friendship should make you better, not worse.

MATTER

This matters because it highlights the influence friends have on each other. It connects to choosing positive friends, teamwork, and supporting others. Good friendships help you grow into your best self.